Swimming Against the Tide

DHRUV RATHEE

29

YouTube Channel
DHRUV RATHEE VLOGS

Based in BERLIN

SUBSCRIBERS
20.8 million

"Even if they shut down my YouTube channel tomorrow, at least I will be proud enough to say that I didn't bow down to them, but until the last breath, I raised my voice to safeguard the nation's democracy and its Constitution"

The Left's voice of reason, the right's favourite punching bag, Dhruv Rathee in the past three months has seen his popularity soar, commenting on a host of subjects such as the farmers' protest, the agitation in Ladakh, electoral bonds and doing a series of videos on the alleged dangers posed by the Narendra Modi-led government. Holding a master's degree in mechanical and renewable energy engineering, he refuses to subscribe to any labels. "Rationalism, liberty, freedom of speech, respect for all religions, tolerance and progress for nation are values I believe in and it's where my ideology lies," says Rathee, who dates his interest in politics to the 2011 anti-corruption movement. Ask him if he'd consider a career in politics, and he says he has no interest currently, only to clarify, "Who knows 30-40 years from now things change and situations too?"



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Rathee company are Ranveer Allahbadia aka BeerBiceps, Abhi and Niyu, Unfiltered by Samdish aka Samdish Bhatia, The DeshBhakt aka Akash Banerjee, Nitish Rajput, Soch by Mohak Mangal, AKTK (Aaj Ki Taaza Khabar) run by Garvit and Anuj Bhardwaj, Open Letter, Raj Shamani, Dr Medusa and The Ranting Gola. A young, educated crop themselves, these influencers are slicing and dicing current events as they unfold and presenting them in a lingo and format that the young can easily understand, on platforms that they typically frequent—YouTube, Instagram and X. If Facebook was where the political discourse played out in the 2014 Lok Sabha election, and WhatsApp and Twitter (now X) the prominent tools for dissemination of election messaging in 2019, then 2024 is the YouTube and Insta election when digital video content creators have become the new political pundits and purveyors of information. Able to express what they think without the limita-